



iChat Pad

A new study suggests that patients and doctors alike prefer a virtual session over physical labour to ease patients worries. <http://dgit.in/iChatPad>



Indiana Jones

Disney announced another Indiana Jones movie as if one 'nuke the fridge' was not enough to begin with. <http://dgit.in/JonesMov>

Workshop

- the company it seems to represent.
- Never click links directly in such emails that claim that there is some problem in your account. Go directly to the website using their URL.
- Always check actual destinations of links by hovering your mouse over the link which shows the destination in the lower left corner of your browser.
- The company with whom you have an account will never ask for your credentials via email. Contact the company to check the email's legitimacy.

Don't get scammed

Don't click on the following types of emails or links or pop-ups or tweets or posts for your own good -

- Million dollar winning emails
 - Mails inviting you to play foreign lotteries or card games.
 - Emails with a long sad story followed by a call for help in order to transfer large sums of money or inheritance out of a said country.
- They are all as fake as fake can be.

Keep separate email accounts for work, home and any other use

Keeping separate email IDs not only helps you organise your emails better, it keeps the threats of one online aspect of your life away from the others. There are three basic types that you might need-

- Work - Any job related emails, appointments or anything official.
- Personal - Use this to correspond with friends and family, and also for banking, job hunting and other non-work related important issues.
- Junk - The one email to sign-up anywhere online - social media, restaurants, games, etc. You won't mind this one being overloaded with spam.

Beware of Cookies

Cookies are files that websites store on your device to keep information about you between sessions on that website. Usually they are harmless, but can also be used for targeted advertising or targeted scams by analysing your behaviour online. Here's how to deal with them -

- Set your browser to warn you before any cookies are installed. Most

browsers have a Cookies setting under Privacy Settings.

- Use an antispyware program that can scan cookies for tracking activities. Most antiviruses come with this feature.
- User browser settings or separated applications to delete old and unwanted cookies.

Firefox comes with built in support for this, and "CookieController", "Cookie Manager" for Chrome, and a host of others for any browser that you are using will do the job.

Trust your browser

Sometimes, going through the privacy and security settings of your chosen web browser can give you more security options than any third party or external solutions. Take some time and dig through them to choose what's right for your needs.

Connection Security

Even though you may be following the best practices regarding protecting your online identity, if your connection is insecure, you might as well kiss your online security goodbye. Hence, before you fire up your connection and do all those secure transactions, go through the following checklist-

Secure browsing

Check for a "padlock" or "https" right before the URL that you are browsing.



Cookie controller for Firefox comes with shortcuts that you can add to your toolbar from the Customise option

This indicates that the website has a valid security certificate from a trusted third party like 'VeriSign' and that the information being transmitted from that website is encrypted and won't be of any use to someone who intercepts it.

Use an antivirus, antispyware and a firewall

In today's world, going online without an antivirus is as good as mailing your personal information personally via post and then setting your computer on fire. There is good reason to keep these updated and activated on your system.

- Even the standard firewall on your OS is mostly secure enough.
- There are sufficiently good third party antiviruses and anti spyware available online. Dedicated internet antivirus are also available

Use Your Instincts

Technology might have come a long way in assisting and even exceeding us, but there is a strong reason that we cannot turn off our instincts in any situation that we face. Those instincts are equally useful on the online world as well. If anything sounds or seems suspicious, it is best to avoid it. For example, if the link you are accessing appears to have a lot of random characters, or the person you just started talking to sounds oddly insistent to know your birthday, it's best to listen to that spider-sense and skip this one! Although let us make it very clear, the internet is infinite in its potential and by no means do we want you to be wary of each click that you make. Combine just the right amount of caution and the handy tips above, and you're all set to unleash the internet into your life! **[1]**

KEYLOGGERS

Keyloggers are a special type of program that, if running on your computer, track each and every key press on your keyboard. This, combined with your browsing history, can give a hacker crucial information about anything you do online and even offline. To avoid this, enter sensitive information through on-screen or digital keyboards available from the OS or from the website itself.